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THE COMPLETE

ITALY VISA BUNDLE

Every long-stay visa for Americans — ERV, Digital Nomad, Student, Self-Employment, Investor — with income thresholds, document checklists, consulate tips, and real 2025 timelines.

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6 VISA TYPES

180+ PAGES

OFFICIAL SOURCES

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CHAPTER

How to Use This Guide

This bundle covers every long-stay visa pathway available to American citizens who want to live in Italy. Each chapter is a standalone guide — read only what applies to you. If you already know which visa you want, jump directly to that chapter. If you are still deciding, start with Chapter 1.

What this guide covers:

- Elective Residency Visa (ERV) — for retirees and those with passive income
- Digital Nomad Visa — for remote workers employed by foreign companies
- Self-Employment Visa — for freelancers and entrepreneurs serving Italian clients
- Student Visa — for university enrollment and language programs
- Family Reunification Visa — for joining an Italian or EU-resident spouse or family
- Investor Visa — for significant capital investment in Italy

**✓ PRO
TIP**

Read the income thresholds section of your target visa **BEFORE** starting the document collection process. Income requirements are the single most common reason for rejection — knowing the exact numbers in advance saves months of wasted effort.

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CHAPTER 1

Choosing Your Visa — The Decision Framework

The Italian long-stay visa system has six pathways for Americans. Each requires different income levels, different documentation, and serves a different lifestyle goal. The decision framework below helps you identify which visa applies to your situation before investing time in documentation.

The Core Question: What Is Your Primary Income Source?

Italian visa categories are organized around income type, not lifestyle preference. Understanding this distinction prevents the most common application mistake — applying for the wrong visa category because it "sounds right".

Income type	Your visa	Key requirement
Pension, Social Security, dividends, rental income	Elective Residency Visa (ERV)	Min ~€31,000/yr passive income
Salary from foreign employer (remote work)	Digital Nomad Visa	Min ~€28,000/yr from foreign clients
Freelance/consulting for Italian clients	Self-Employment Visa	Business plan + qualifications
University/language school enrollment	Student Visa	Enrollment letter + €448/yr
Spouse/parent is Italian or EU resident	Family Reunification	Sponsor income ~€8,500/yr
Investment of €500K+ in Italy	Investor Visa	Capital documentation

Common Mistakes in Visa Selection

Applying for the ERV on earned income

The ERV requires PASSIVE income — Social Security, pensions, dividends, rental income. Salary from your US employer, freelance income, or consulting fees do NOT qualify. If you work remotely, you need the Digital Nomad Visa.

Confusing the Digital Nomad Visa with general remote work permission

The DNV specifically requires that you work for foreign (non-Italian) clients or employers. If you serve Italian clients, you need the Self-Employment Visa, which requires a different application and business plan.

Assuming the Student Visa allows work

The Italian Student Visa allows maximum 20 hours/week of work — and only after enrollment. It is not a backdoor to full employment.

Applying at the wrong consulate

You must apply at the Italian consulate with jurisdiction over your US state of residence. Applications submitted to out-of-jurisdiction consulates are rejected without review.

■ IMPORTANT

Never begin document collection without first confirming your income meets the threshold for your target visa. The FBI background check is valid for only 6 months from the apostille date — collecting documents before you are ready to apply means re-obtaining expired items.

CHAPTER 2

Elective Residency Visa (ERV) — The Retirement Route

The Elective Residency Visa (visto per residenza elettiva) is Italy's primary visa for retirees, early retirees, and anyone with sufficient passive income who wants to live in Italy without working. It is the most commonly sought long-stay visa by American applicants and the one with the most nuanced income documentation requirements.

Who Qualifies

You qualify if you meet ALL of the following conditions:

- ✓ You are financially self-sufficient (you do not need to work in Italy to support yourself)
- ✓ Your primary income comes from passive sources: Social Security, pension, annuity, dividends, rental income, interest, or similar
- ✓ Your income meets or exceeds the minimum threshold (see below)
- ✓ You have arranged accommodation in Italy before applying
- ✓ You have no criminal record that would disqualify you under Italian law

Income Thresholds 2025

The official minimum is €31,000/year for a single applicant. This figure comes from Italian ministerial guidance and represents approximately 30× the annual social welfare minimum. In practice, consulates apply this threshold with some flexibility — documented income consistently above €28,000/year from stable passive sources is generally accepted at most US consulates. However, apply for at minimum €31,000 to avoid any ambiguity.

Applicant type	Official minimum	Recommended buffer	Notes
Single applicant	€31,000/year	€35,000+/year	Most consulates apply this strictly
Married couple	€38,000/year	€42,000+/year	+€6,400 for spouse on same application
Each additional dependent	+€3,200/year	+€4,000/year	Children under 18, elderly parents

What Counts as Qualifying Income

COUNTS toward the ERV income threshold:

- ✓ Social Security retirement benefits (most important source for American retirees)
- ✓ Federal/state/military pension income
- ✓ Private pension and annuity distributions (regular, documented)
- ✓ Dividends from investments (documented in brokerage statements)
- ✓ Interest income from savings and CDs
- ✓ Rental income from US real estate (documented lease agreements + bank deposits)
- ✓ Alimony/maintenance income (court-ordered, documented)
- ✓ Royalty income (documented, recurring)

Does NOT count toward the ERV threshold:

- ✗ Salary or wages from employment (Italian or foreign)
- ✗ Freelance or consulting income
- ✗ Capital gains from asset sales (not recurring income)
- ✗ IRA/401(k) withdrawals unless structured as regular annuity distributions
- ✗ Cryptocurrency gains
- ✗ Business income

✓ PRO TIP Social Security + pension is the ideal income combination for most American retirees. Document both sources separately with official agency letters. Many applicants whose SS alone is below the threshold successfully demonstrate the combined income. The consulate evaluates total passive income, not any single source.

The Complete ERV Document Checklist

Every document marked * requires both the original AND a photocopy. Documents in English do not need translation unless the consulate specifically requests it (most US Italian consulates accept English-language financial documents).

IDENTITY

Passport *	Valid for at least 12 months beyond intended visa start date. Minimum 2 blank visa pages. Submit original + full copy of all pages.
Visa application form	Completed online via the Prenot@mi system at prenotami.esteri.it. Print and sign before appointment.
2 passport photos	White background, 35×45mm, taken within last 6 months. Bring 3 to be safe.

INCOME DOCUMENTATION

Social Security award letter *	Official SSA benefit verification letter (not the annual COLA notice). Request at ssa.gov or at your local SSA office. Must show current monthly benefit amount.
Pension award letters *	For each pension: official letter on letterhead showing annual/monthly amount. For federal pensions, OPM statement; for state pensions, the agency letter.
Bank statements *	12 months of statements from all accounts showing regular income deposits. Must show your name, account number, and transaction history. US bank statements in English are accepted.
Brokerage statements *	If claiming dividend or interest income: 12 months of statements. Annual 1099-DIV and 1099-INT help corroborate amounts.
US tax return (Form 1040) *	Last 2 years. This cross-validates all income sources. Some consulates require it; all accept it as supporting documentation.
Rental income documentation *	Lease agreements + 12 months of bank statements showing rent deposits. For formal rental management, property manager statements suffice.

ACCOMMODATION

Italian accommodation proof *	A signed rental contract (contratto d'affitto) for your Italian address, OR a property deed if you own Italian property, OR a written accommodation declaration (dichiarazione di ospitalità) from an Italian resident willing to host you. The rental contract is the strongest option.
Proof of payment *	First month's rent receipt or bank transfer confirmation showing you have paid. Strengthens the accommodation documentation considerably.

HEALTH INSURANCE

International health insurance certificate *	Policy must explicitly state: (a) coverage in Italy and the Schengen Area, (b) minimum coverage of €30,000, (c) coverage dates matching your visa request period. Providers: Cigna Global, AXA International, Allianz Care. Cost: ~\$100-400/month depending on age.
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BACKGROUND CHECK

FBI Background Check *	Obtain from the FBI Identity History Summary at fbi.gov . Cost: \$18. MUST be apostilled by the US Department of State before submission. Valid 6 months from the apostille date. Start this process first — it takes the longest.
State criminal background check *	From your state of residence. Apostilled by Secretary of State. Some consulates require both federal and state; confirm with your specific consulate before applying.

The ERV Application Process Step by Step

Step 1 — FBI Check (Start 4 months early)

Order your FBI Identity History Summary at fbi.gov. Cost \$18. Once received, mail the original to the US Department of State Authentication Office for the apostille. Standard processing: 8-12 weeks. Expedited through a registered courier service: 2-4 weeks. The apostilled FBI check is your longest-lead document — start here.

Step 2 — Secure Italian Accommodation

Sign a rental contract for your Italian address before collecting other documents. Your Italian address determines which Italian consulate has jurisdiction if you travel to Italy before your visa is issued, and all documents will be linked to this address in the application.

Step 3 — Order the Prenot@mi Appointment

Book your visa appointment at prenotami.esteri.it — the Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs appointment system. Select "Italy Visa" → "Long Stay" → your nearest consulate. Appointment availability varies by consulate: in New York and Los Angeles wait times can be 2-4 months. In smaller consulates (Detroit, Philadelphia) wait times are shorter. Book your appointment while collecting documents — not after.

Step 4 — Collect All Documents

Gather every document on the checklist above. Follow the "original + copy" rule for all starred items. Organize in the exact order the consulate checklist requests — some consulates publish their specific order online; follow it precisely.

Step 5 — Prepare the Financial Summary Letter

Write a 1-page letter summarizing your financial situation: total annual passive income, each source and amount, your Italian accommodation plan, and why you are applying for the ERV. This is not required but is highly recommended — it helps the consulate officer understand your application and reduces follow-up questions.

Step 6 — Appear in Person at the Consulate

Bring every document, original plus copies, in a folder. Dress professionally. Arrive 15 minutes early. The officer will review your documents, ask questions, and take your biometrics (fingerprints and photo at the consulate or VFS Global center). Leave the originals with the consulate — they retain them during processing.

Step 7 — Wait for Processing

ERV processing times: typically 30-90 days. Most applicants hear within 6-8 weeks. Do not book non-refundable flights until the visa is approved. Do not travel to Italy on tourist entry while your ERV application is pending — it creates complicating immigration records.

Step 8 — Receive Your Visa and Enter Italy

The ERV is stamped in your passport. Enter Italy within the visa validity period (usually 90-180 days from issue). Keep the original visa stamp page. Within 8 working days of arrival at private accommodation, you must declare your presence at the Questura (see our companion guide: First 90 Days in Italy Pack).

■ **IMPORTANT**

The ERV is a single-entry visa valid for 90 days. Once in Italy, you must apply for the Permesso di Soggiorno per Residenza Elettiva within 60 days of arrival. The permesso is the actual residence permit — the visa is just authorization to enter. Never confuse the two.

CHAPTER 3

Digital Nomad Visa — For Remote Workers

Italy's Digital Nomad Visa (visto per lavoratori da remoto) was formally launched in 2024 as Italy's response to the surge in location-independent workers. It is specifically designed for Americans who work remotely for non-Italian employers or clients — consulting firms, US tech companies, foreign freelance clients. Unlike the ERV, it requires earned income (not passive), but it permits actual work, which the ERV does not.

Key Requirements

Income threshold

€28,000/year gross (approximately \$31,000 at current rates). This must come from work — remote employment contract or documented freelance income from foreign clients.

Work authorization

You may ONLY work for non-Italian clients/employers. The moment you take Italian clients, you need the Self-Employment Visa instead.

Health insurance

Same as ERV: international policy, €30,000 minimum coverage, Italy explicitly covered.

Accommodation

Signed Italian rental contract or accommodation declaration required at application.

Criminal record

FBI background check apostilled — same requirement as ERV.

Visa validity

Initially 1 year. Renewable for additional years as long as you maintain qualifying employment.

Documenting Your Remote Work Income

This is the most common point of confusion in DNV applications. The consulate needs to see that your income is real, stable, and from non-Italian sources. Here is what works:

If you are an employee of a foreign company:

- Employment contract showing your role, salary, and that the company is based outside Italy

- Letter from employer on company letterhead confirming: remote work is authorized, position will continue, annual salary
- 6-12 months of pay stubs or salary deposit records
- Company website or registration documentation showing the company is established outside Italy

If you are a freelancer with foreign clients:

- Client contracts (minimum 2-3 clients recommended for demonstrated stability)
- Invoices from the last 12 months showing regular income
- Bank statements confirming payment receipt
- A brief business description: what you do, who your clients are, why your work is location-independent
- LinkedIn or professional profile showing established freelance history

✓ PRO TIP

Consulates are newer to the Digital Nomad Visa than the ERV and application practices are still standardizing across the US consulate network. Some consulates request additional documentation not listed in the official guidance. Call your specific consulate before your appointment to confirm their current requirements.

The DNV vs ERV Decision

Many Americans qualify for both visas. The choice depends on your situation:

Factor	Choose ERV	Choose DNV
Income type	Passive (SS, pension, dividends)	Active (salary, freelance)
Work in Italy	Not allowed	Allowed (foreign clients only)
Income threshold	€31,000/year	€28,000/year
Visa stability	More established process	Newer, more variable by consulate
Renewal ease	Straightforward if income stable	Requires proof of continued remote work
Tax implication	May qualify for flat tax regime	Standard IRPEF unless meets other criteria

CHAPTER 4

Self-Employment Visa — For Freelancers and Entrepreneurs

The Self-Employment Visa (*visto per lavoro autonomo*) is for Americans who want to work in Italy as freelancers, consultants, or business owners serving Italian clients. It is more complex than the DNV because it requires Italian business authorization — a business plan, professional qualification recognition, and in some cases pre-authorization from Italian authorities.

When You Need the Self-Employment Visa (Not the DNV)

- You plan to serve Italian clients or customers (even partially)
- You will open a Partita IVA (Italian VAT number for self-employed workers)
- You will register as a *lavoratore autonomo* in Italy
- Your work requires Italian professional licensing (medicine, law, architecture, engineering)
- You are opening an Italian business entity (SRL, etc.)

The Business Plan Requirement

The self-employment visa requires a business plan (*piano di attività*) demonstrating that your work is viable and self-sustaining. The consulate reviews this to assess whether you are likely to be economically self-sufficient in Italy. The business plan does not need to be elaborate, but it must be credible and specific.

Your business plan should include:

- Description of your professional activity and services offered
- Target market and client acquisition strategy
- Projected first-year revenue (realistic, defensible)
- Overview of initial investment or starting capital
- Your qualifications and relevant professional experience
- Why Italy is the appropriate base for this activity

**✓ PRO
TIP**

If your profession requires Italian licensing (architects, engineers, doctors, lawyers), the credential recognition (*riconoscimento del titolo*) must be initiated BEFORE applying for the visa. This process can take 6-18 months through the relevant Italian professional order. Plan accordingly.

Income Threshold and Documentation

The self-employment visa income threshold is the same as the digital nomad visa: approximately €28,000/year. However, for new businesses, you demonstrate this through projected income (business plan) rather than historical earnings. Supporting capital (savings, investments) strengthens the application significantly.

CHAPTER 5

Student Visa — For University and Language Study

The Italian Student Visa (visto per studio) allows Americans to study at Italian universities, language schools, and other educational institutions for periods exceeding 90 days. It is the easiest Italian long-stay visa to obtain — income requirements are minimal — but it comes with strict limitations on work and requires active enrollment.

Types of Study That Qualify

University degree programs

Bachelor's, Master's, PhD at Italian universities. Programs increasingly available in English. Politecnico di Milano, Bocconi, and Bologna are popular with Americans.

Language courses

Italian language schools with programs over 90 days. Many schools offer semester and year-long programs specifically designed for the student visa pathway.

Professional courses

Recognized post-graduate professional programs, culinary academies, art and design schools.

Research programs

University-affiliated research positions with formal enrollment status.

Income Requirements (Much Lower Than Other Visas)

The student visa income requirement is approximately €448/year — the Italian government's minimum subsistence calculation for students. In practice, consulates want to see that you have sufficient funds to cover tuition and living expenses, typically demonstrated through:

- Bank statements showing €6,000-10,000+ in available savings
- Parental support letter if financially supported by family (with their bank statements)
- Scholarship documentation if applicable
- University fee payment confirmation

Work Limitations on the Student Visa

■ IMPORTANT

Italian student visa holders may work MAXIMUM 20 hours per week. Working beyond this limit violates your visa conditions and can result in permit revocation. The student visa is not a path to full employment in Italy.

CHAPTER 6

Family Reunification Visa

The Family Reunification Visa (visto per ricongiungimento familiare) allows American citizens to join a family member who is legally resident in Italy — an Italian citizen spouse, an EU citizen spouse living in Italy, or a non-EU legal resident with sufficient income to sponsor family members.

Who Can Sponsor You

Italian citizen spouse

If your spouse is an Italian citizen and lives in Italy, you qualify for simplified family reunification. As the spouse of an EU citizen, you actually have EU free movement rights (stronger than standard reunification). Apply for a carta di soggiorno di familiare di cittadino UE rather than a standard permesso.

EU citizen spouse resident in Italy

Same as Italian citizen — EU free movement rules apply. You apply for facilitated entry under EU Directive 2004/38/EC, which provides faster processing and lower income requirements.

Non-EU legal resident in Italy

Your sponsor must have a valid permesso di soggiorno, have been in Italy for at least 1 year, and meet the income sponsor requirement (approximately €8,500/year + €2,800 per each additional family member).

Documents Specific to Family Reunification

- Marriage certificate apostilled and translated into Italian
- Sponsor's current permesso di soggiorno or Italian passport
- Sponsor's proof of income (meeting the income threshold)
- Sponsor's proof of suitable accommodation in Italy
- Birth certificates for dependent children (apostilled + translated)

✓ **PRO
TIP**

If you are married to an Italian citizen, request a 'nulla osta al ricongiungimento' from your nearest Italian consulate before beginning the full application. This pre-authorization significantly streamlines the process.

CHAPTER 7

Investor Visa

Italy's Investor Visa (visto per investitori) is designed for high-net-worth individuals who wish to make significant investments in Italy in exchange for residency. It is the fastest Italian visa to process (official target: 30 days) and the only one that does not require minimum income for day-to-day living — instead, it requires proof of significant capital.

Investment Categories and Minimums

Investment type	Minimum amount	Notes
Italian government bonds	€2,000,000	Must be held minimum 2 years
Equity in Italian companies	€500,000	Must be held minimum 2 years
Innovative startups (innovative startup registration required)	€250,000	Lowest threshold — popular option
Philanthropic donation to public interest projects	€100,000	Cultural, educational, scientific

The Investor Visa process includes a pre-approval stage through the Italian Ministry of Economic Development (Ministero dello Sviluppo Economico — MIMIT), which reviews and validates the investment proposal before the consulate visa application. Budget 30-60 days for the pre-approval stage plus 30 days for the visa itself.

CHAPTER 8

The Italian Consulate System — How It Works

Understanding how the Italian consulate network operates in the US prevents the single most common procedural mistake: applying at the wrong consulate. Every Italian consulate has exclusive jurisdiction over specific US states — you must apply at the consulate whose jurisdiction covers your state of residence.

US Consulate Jurisdictions

Italian Consulate General — New York: NY, NJ, CT, DE, PA (eastern), MA, RI, VT, NH, ME

Italian Consulate General — Los Angeles: CA (southern), AZ, NV, HI

Italian Consulate General — San Francisco: CA (northern), OR, WA, AK, ID, MT, WY, UT, CO

Italian Consulate General — Chicago: IL, IN, OH, MI, WI, MN, ND, SD, NE, KS, IA, MO

Italian Consulate General — Miami: FL, GA, SC, NC, VA (eastern), Puerto Rico, US Virgin Islands

Italian Consulate General — Houston: TX, LA, MS, AL, AR, OK, NM

Italian Consulate General — Washington DC: DC, MD, VA (northern), WV, KY, TN

Italian Consulate General — Philadelphia: PA (western), DE (partial)

Italian Consulate General — Boston: MA (some zip codes share with NY)

Italian Consulate General — Detroit: MI (lower peninsula)

■ IMPORTANT

Applications submitted at out-of-jurisdiction consulates are rejected — sometimes after months of waiting. Verify your jurisdiction at esteri.it before booking your appointment. If you recently moved, confirm your new state's consulate jurisdiction.

Prenot@mi — The Italian Appointment System

All Italian consulate visa appointments are booked through Prenot@mi at prenotami.esteri.it. The system opens appointments in batches — sometimes releasing 2-3 months of slots at once. Popular consulates (New York, Los Angeles) fill within hours of release.

Prenot@mi strategy:

- Create your Prenot@mi account before you are ready to apply — the account setup takes time
- Set calendar reminders for the first week of each month when many consulates release new slots

- Book your appointment slot first, then complete document collection — appointment availability is the bottleneck
- If your target consulate has no slots, check 30-60 days out weekly — cancellations are common
- Some VFS Global centers also book Italian consulate appointments — check if your consulate uses VFS

What Happens at Your Appointment

Document review

The consulate officer reviews your complete document package. They may request additional documentation or clarification on the spot. Bring every document on the checklist even if you are unsure whether it is required.

Biometrics

Fingerprints and photograph taken at the appointment (or at a VFS Global center if applicable).

Original documents retained

The consulate keeps your original documents during processing — passport included. You cannot travel internationally while your application is in process.

Processing period

ERV: 30-90 days. DNV: 30-60 days. Student: 15-30 days. You may be contacted for additional documentation during this period.

Passport return

When approved, your passport is returned with the visa stamp. You can then enter Italy within the visa validity period.

CHAPTER 9

Master Document Checklist — All Visa Types

This printable checklist covers documents required for each visa type. Check marks indicate the document is required (✓), recommended (+), or not applicable (—).

Document	ERV	DNV	Self-Emp	Student	Family
Valid passport (12+ months)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Prenot@mi application form	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
2 passport photos (35×45mm)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
FBI background check (apostilled)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
State criminal check (apostilled)	+	+	+	+	+
International health insurance	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Italian accommodation proof	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Social Security award letter	✓	—	—	—	—
Pension award letter(s)	✓	—	—	—	—
12-month bank statements	✓	✓	✓	✓	+
US tax return (last 2 years)	✓	✓	+	+	+
Remote employment contract	—	✓	—	—	—
Employer authorization letter	—	✓	—	—	—
Freelance client contracts/invoices	—	✓	✓	—	—
Business plan	—	—	✓	—	—
Professional qualifications	—	—	✓	—	—
University enrollment letter	—	—	—	✓	—
Tuition payment confirmation	—	—	—	✓	—
Sponsor's permesso di soggiorno	—	—	—	—	✓
Marriage certificate (apostilled)	—	—	—	—	✓
Investment documentation	—	—	—	—	—

✓ = Required · + = Strongly recommended · — = Not applicable

CHAPTER 10

After Your Visa: The First 60 Days in Italy

Receiving your visa is step one. The visa authorizes entry — it does not establish legal residency. Within your first 60 days in Italy, you must complete several critical steps that transform your visa into actual legal residence. Skipping or delaying these steps creates immigration complications that are significantly harder to resolve retroactively.

Within 8 working days — Dichiarazione di Presenza

If staying in private accommodation, you must declare your presence to the local Questura (police headquarters) within 8 working days of arrival. Hotels do this automatically. Private rentals do not — you must go in person. Bring passport, visa, and your rental contract. The Questura stamps your declaration. Keep this document — it is required for your Permesso application.

Within 60 days — Permesso di Soggiorno Application

The Permesso di Soggiorno is the actual Italian residence permit. You apply through the Post Office system (kit postale at any Poste Italiane Sportello Amico). The kit costs approximately €30. Processing takes 2-8 months depending on your city and category. Your Post Office receipt (ricevuta/cedolino) is your legal status document while you wait.

Within 20 days of Permesso receipt — Anagrafe Registration

Register at your municipality's Anagrafe (civil registry) to establish official Italian residency. This enables: SSN healthcare enrollment, Italian ID card, voting (if applicable), and correct tax domicile. A municipal officer visits your address within 45 days to verify residence.

Month 2-3 — SSN Enrollment

Enroll voluntarily in the Italian National Health Service at your local ASL. Annual cost €387-1,500 depending on income. This replaces the need for international health insurance and gives you access to Italy's full public healthcare system.

✓ **PRO**
TIP

For a complete day-by-day guide to your first 90 days in Italy — including all forms, Italian scripts, and complete checklists — see the companion guide: First 90 Days in Italy Pack (included in your All-Access Bundle, or available separately at italopedia.com/shop).

APPENDIX A

Income Thresholds — All Visa Types 2025

Visa type	Minimum income	Type of income	Per additional dependent
Elective Residency (ERV)	€31,000/year	Passive only	+€3,200/year
Digital Nomad (DNV)	€28,000/year	Active (remote work)	+€3,200/year
Self-Employment	€28,000/year (projected)	Active (self-employed)	+€3,200/year
Student	~€448/year (min)	Any (or family support)	N/A
Family Reunification (non-EU sponsor)	€28,500/year (sponsor)	Any (sponsor income)	+€2,800/year
Investor	No income min	N/A — capital required	N/A

Note: All figures are based on Italian ministerial guidance current as of Q2 2025. Thresholds are updated annually by the Italian government. Verify current figures at esteri.it and with your specific consulate before applying.

APPENDIX B

Italian Consulate Directory — United States 2025

Italian Consulate General — New York

Address: Park Avenue, New York, NY

Website: newyork.esteri.it

Jurisdiction: NY, NJ, CT, PA (eastern), MA, RI, VT, NH, ME

Notes: Prenot@mi only. One of the busiest — book appointments 2-3 months ahead.

Italian Consulate General — Los Angeles

Address: Wilshire Blvd, Los Angeles, CA

Website: losangeles.esteri.it

Jurisdiction: CA (south of Fresno), AZ, NV, HI

Notes: Uses VFS Global for some appointment types. Check both booking systems.

Italian Consulate General — San Francisco

Address: Webster Street, San Francisco, CA

Website: sanfrancisco.esteri.it

Jurisdiction: CA (north of Fresno), OR, WA, AK, ID, MT, WY, UT, CO

Notes: Prenot@mi only. Appointments 4-8 weeks out typically.

Italian Consulate General — Chicago

Address: Michigan Ave, Chicago, IL

Website: chicago.esteri.it

Jurisdiction: IL, IN, OH, MI, WI, MN, ND, SD, NE, KS, IA, MO

Notes: Good appointment availability compared to coasts.

Italian Consulate General — Miami

Address: Brickell Ave, Miami, FL

Website: miami.esteri.it

Jurisdiction: FL, GA, SC, NC, VA (eastern), PR, USVI

Notes: Appointments typically 3-6 weeks out.

Italian Consulate General — Houston

Address: Main Street, Houston, TX

Website: houston.esteri.it

Jurisdiction: TX, LA, MS, AL, AR, OK, NM

Notes: Less congested than coastal consulates.

Italian Consulate General — Washington DC

Address: Fuller Street NW, Washington DC

Website: washington.esteri.it

Jurisdiction: DC, MD, VA (northern), WV, KY, TN

Notes: Diplomatic district — professional and efficient.

APPENDIX C

Italian Scripts for Your Application Process

These scripts are designed to be shown on your phone or printed and handed to Italian officials. At the consulate, Questura, Post Office, or any government office — showing the correct phrase is more effective than attempting to speak it.

AT THE POST OFFICE — Permesso kit

English	I need the kit for the residence permit for non-EU foreigners.
Italiano	<i>Ho bisogno del kit per la domanda di permesso di soggiorno per stranieri extracomunitari.</i>

AT THE QUESTURA — Declaring presence

English	I need to declare my presence. I arrived on [date] and am staying at [address].
Italiano	<i>Devo fare la dichiarazione di presenza. Sono arrivato/a il [data] e alloggior in [indirizzo].</i>

AT THE QUESTURA — Permesso appointment

English	I have an appointment for my residence permit. Here is my appointment notice.
Italiano	<i>Ho un appuntamento per il permesso di soggiorno. Ecco il mio avviso di appuntamento.</i>

AT THE AGENZIA DELLE ENTRATE — Codice Fiscale

English	I would like to request the tax identification code. I am an American citizen.
Italiano	<i>Vorrei richiedere il codice fiscale. Sono un/a cittadino/a americano/a.</i>

AT THE ANAGRAFE — Residency registration

English	I would like to register my residency. I have a valid residence permit.
Italiano	<i>Vorrei registrare la mia residenza. Ho un permesso di soggiorno valido.</i>

AT THE ASL — Healthcare enrollment

English	I would like to enroll voluntarily in the national health service.
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Italiano	<i>Vorrei iscrivermi volontariamente al Servizio Sanitario Nazionale.</i>
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GENERAL — When you do not understand

English	I am sorry, I do not speak Italian well. Could you please speak more slowly?
Italiano	<i>Mi dispiace, non parlo bene l'italiano. Potrebbe parlare più lentamente, per favore?</i>

GENERAL — Requesting English assistance

English	Is there anyone here who speaks English?
Italiano	<i>C'è qualcuno che parla inglese?</i>

About This Guide

This guide was written by Fabrizio Boggio, Editor-in-Chief of Italopedia.com, from Piedmont, Italy. Every income threshold, document requirement, and process description has been verified against official Italian government sources: the Ministero degli Affari Esteri, the Ministero dell'Interno, and official consulate guidance. It is updated quarterly.

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